



A wristband that tracks your life

Larklife wristbands (one for day and the other for night) track your activity, diet and sleep; analyse the information holistically; and provide personalised recommendations to improve your lifestyle. Larklife provides context-aware advice—for example, if you did not get enough sleep in the night, it will suggest you a protein-rich breakfast to ensure enough energy.

Inside: An intelligent triaxial accelerometer helps pick up even micro-movements of the user's body, while dietary information needs to be fed into the system. Bluetooth Smart helps synchronise this information with an iOS application on your mobile device. A continuous machine learning algorithm analyses the user's activity and learns about his energy patterns. The techniques are apparently based on the science of circadian rhythms, or how individuals' energy levels peak and dip. Lithium-polymer battery provides up to 48-hour working. Other components include micro-USB connector, vibration motor, clock and snazzy LED lights to grab your attention.

Bandai strengthens its bond with kids

Bandai created magic with Tamagotchi as early as 1996. Its new TechPet robot dog promises to be all the more phenomenal. It starts with a simple, free iTunes application, which lets kids take care of a digital pet. You can feed it, monitor its health, give it medicines, play with it, and do much more. However, the real kick lies in the robot model or toy, whatever you want to call it. Dock your iPhone or iPod Touch as the face of the pet, and it is ready to wag its tail and play with you. The robot toy is capable of walking front and back, turning 360-degree and dancing.

Inside: This application-based toy works with an iPhone or iPod touch docked to the robot dog through a 3.5mm jack. iPhone's Facetime camera allows voice and gesture control. Bluetooth lets the robot interact and play with other TechPets. The robot dog is powered by three AA-size batteries.



Making electricity safe and smart

Canadian company 2D2C, which makes electrical safety equipment, has launched the SafePlug energy manager kit that adds intelligence to normal power sockets. The outlets provide child safety and surge protection, monitor power consumption of devices connected to them, automatically switch off devices not in use, and also enable remote control of the outlet. Overall, the system promises 30 per cent savings in electricity bills.

Inside: The kit comprises SafePlug energy manager outlets, a server, an application that can run on most mobile devices and Web browsers, and SafePlug Upgrade tags. The server and outlets communicate wirelessly using Zigbee Pro—a low-power networking technology that enables the devices to connect to each other and ultimately form a mesh network. The server can, in turn, connect to the device that runs the application using Ethernet or Wi-Fi. Outlets contain patented overload, shock and power fault circuit interrupter technologies. SafePlug Upgrade tags communicate appliance power and current rating to outlets. There are around 13 tags available, and for an appliance to receive power from an outlet, it must be updated by adding the tag that best matches its power or current rating.

